# Music Video Generator 4.2

User Manual

From song to finished music video – in five steps

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# 1. Overview

The Music Video Generator (MVG) automatically turns a music file plus your video clips and photos into a music video. It detects the beat of the song and places every cut exactly on it. You decide the material, the formats and the extras – the program does the editing.

Version 4.2 guides you through five clear steps:

| Step | What you do there |
|---|---|
| 1 Start | Choose music, tick the output formats |
| 2 Footage | Collect clips and photos – from the pool, from folders or by dragging them into the window |
| 3 Extras | Pre-intro, intro, outro, title and cutting speed |
| 4 Edit | Check the planned clip order, move or replace clips, create the video |
| 5 Done | Watch the video, choose a YouTube thumbnail, upload or change clips afterwards |

## New in version 4.2

- Pre-intro, intro and outro can be chosen: if there are several videos in the folder, you pick a specific one or “Random” in step 3.
- Logs neatly in the logs/ folder; the error log is kept small automatically.

## New in version 4.1

- Report a problem (⚙ menu and on errors): puts an error report as a ZIP file on the desktop – to send to the developer. It only contains logs and technical details, no videos.
- Empty cache as its own entry in the ⚙ menu, showing the size.
- Clips in special formats (e.g. 4K or HEVC from a phone) are prepared with progress in percent – the display no longer seems to stand still.
- More protection against hangs: if ffmpeg does not respond for 5 minutes, the step is stopped with a clear message instead of waiting forever. Interrupted preparations no longer leave broken files.
- More detailed logs, including the previous session.

## New in version 4.0

- Guided workflow in five steps instead of one big settings window – the simple mode is gone.
- A single clip pool (folder clips/) instead of mood folders; material from every source ends up in one shared selection.
- Files and folders can be dragged into the window in every step.
- The clip order is shown before rendering and can be rearranged; while rendering you see live how the video is built.
- Later changes only re-render the sections that changed.
- Automatic YouTube thumbnail (1280×720) with the option to pick another picture.
- Appearance light, dark or like Windows; language switch without restart.
- Whole clip: if no cutting speed is selected, every clip plays in full – the cut is at the end of the clip, on the beat.
- Only one clip: it automatically loops through the whole song – seamlessly or as a boomerang, on the beat.
- Thumbnail tool palette: pick any frame, text with fonts, colours, outline and shadow, your own logo and templates.
- Time left while rendering (“approx. 2 min left”), a soft ending without an outro (picture and sound fade out) and file dialogs that remember the folders you used last.
- Click help also in the thumbnail editor and in the pool window (its own “?” button).
- About MVG in the ⚙ menu: version with update check (new versions are shown at the top), licenses, links and a way to support MVG.
- Fixed: with a pre-intro the title appeared too early – it now always appears after pre-intro and intro.

# 2. Program folders and files

All folders are next to the program file (EXE). Missing folders are created automatically at start-up.

| Folder | Contents |
|---|---|
| clips/ | Your clip pool: videos and photos you use again and again. Ships empty – please fill it yourself. |
| intro/ | Intro videos (silent at the start of the song). With several files chosen at random or in step 3. |
| outro/ | Outro videos with their own sound (after the music). Random if several, or chosen in step 3. |
| pre-intro/ | Pre-intro videos with their own sound (before the music). Random if several, or chosen in step 3. |
| output/ | Finished videos and YouTube thumbnails. The program never deletes anything here. |
| output/Shorts/ | Shorts created with “Short from URL”. |
| manual/ | The three PDF manuals (Deutsch, English, Español). The program puts them here from the EXE at start. |
| logo/ | Your own logos for the thumbnail editor. At first it contains the MVG logo as an example. |
| cache/normalized/ | Clips in unusual formats, prepared once (speeds up further renders). Cleaned up automatically: anything unused for 60 days is deleted, 5 GB at most in total. |
| cache/segments/ | Rendered sections of the current video – this makes later changes fast. Emptied automatically at every program start and with “New video”. |
| logs/ | The program's logs (errors, sequence, FFmpeg). Kept small automatically; for an error report: ⚙ → Report a problem. |
| cache/thumbs/ | Small thumbnails for the pool, the selection and the clip order. Cleaned up automatically: deleted after 30 days unused, 300 MB at most. |
| ffmpeg/, Sound/ | Program components – do not change. |

## Supported file formats

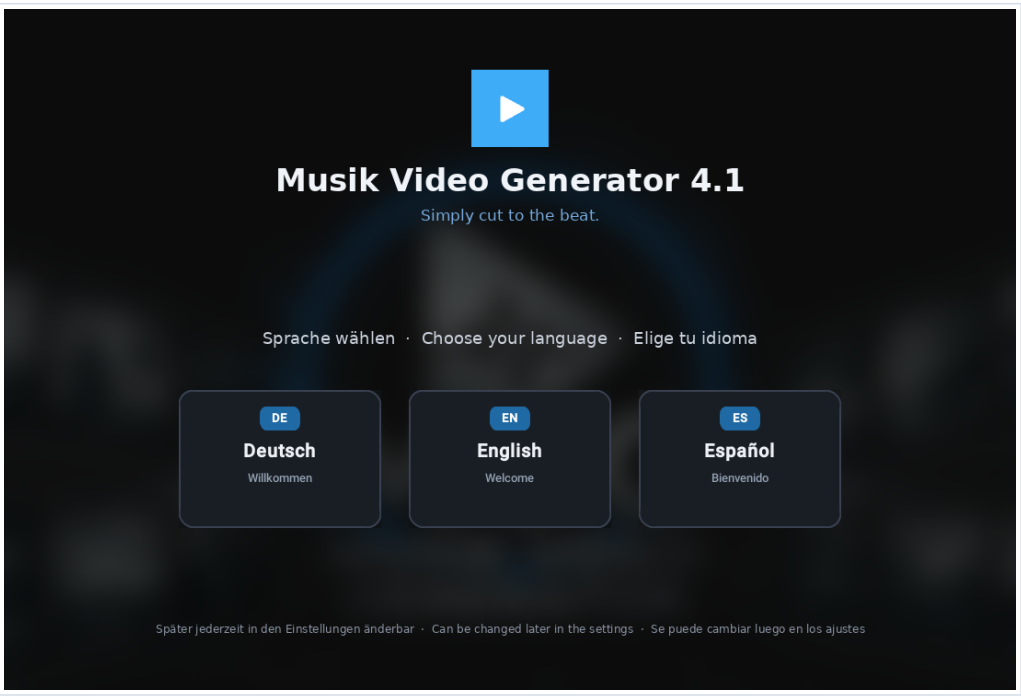
| Type | Formats |
|---|---|
| Music | MP3, WAV, FLAC, OGG |
| Video | MP4, MOV, MKV, AVI, WEBM |
| Photos | JPG, JPEG, PNG, WEBP |

### Settings and logs

Language and appearance are stored in mvg_settings.json. The logs are in the logs/ folder: mvg_error.log (program errors), mvg_start.log (sequence with times) and mvg_ffmpeg.log (FFmpeg output), the last two also from the previous session (..._vorher.log). The program keeps them small: the sequence and FFmpeg logs only exist for the current and previous session, the error log keeps the most recent entries. The easiest way to send everything is ⚙ → Report a problem.

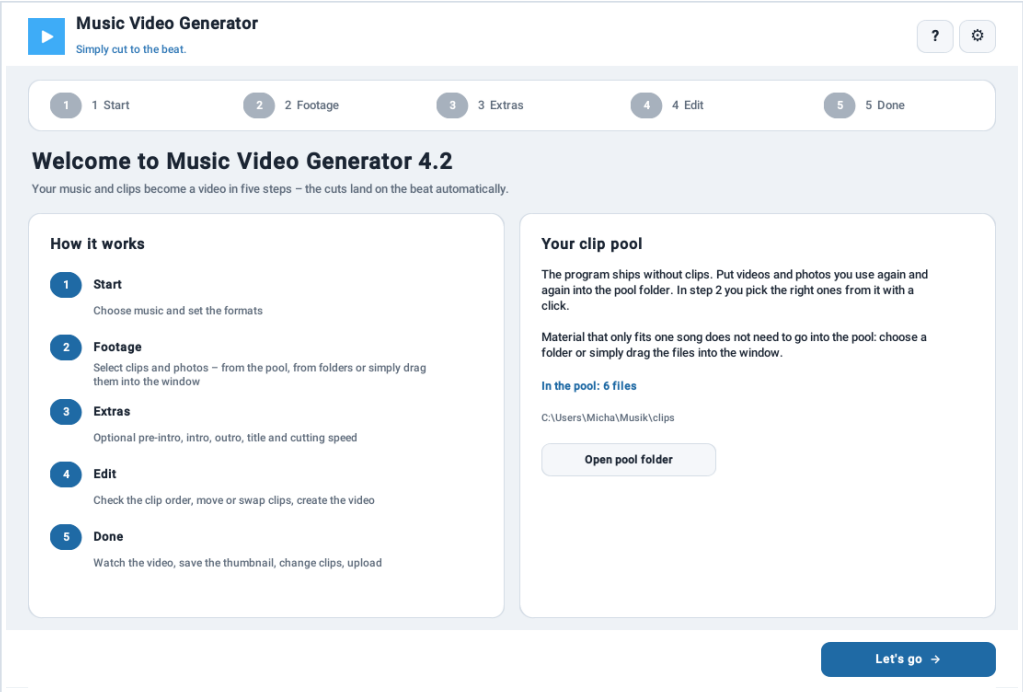
# 3. First start

On the very first start the program asks for the language: Deutsch, English or Español. One click on the card is enough. You can change the language any time later in the ⚙ menu – without restarting.




*Language selection on first start*

After that the welcome page appears once. It explains the steps and points out the most important thing: the program ships without clips. Put your standard clips into the pool folder (“Open pool folder”), then they are available for every video.




*Welcome page with the clip pool note*

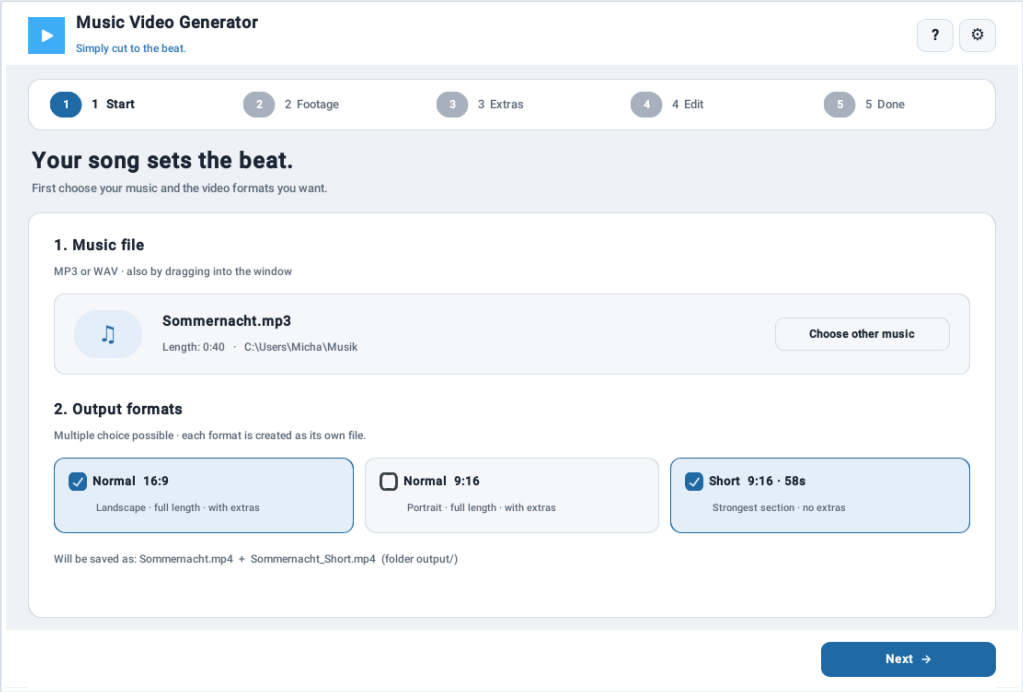
# 4. User interface

Every page is built the same way:

- Header: program name and the slogan “Simply cut to the beat.” (the version is in the title bar), on the right “?” (click help) and “⚙” (settings and help).
- Step bar: shows the current step. Completed steps have a tick and can be clicked.
- Content area: the settings of the current step.
- Footer: “Back” on the left, the status line in the middle, “Next” or the main action of the step on the right.

> The status line is the first place to look when a button stays grey or nothing happens – it tells you what is missing.

# 5. Step 1 – Start




*Step 1: music and output formats*

## Music file

Click “Choose music file” or drag the file into the window. Name, length and folder are shown. The file name decides the video name: “MySong.mp3” becomes “MySong.mp4”. The same name can be shown as a title – if you want a different title, rename the music file. The file dialog always opens in the folder you used last – this also applies to videos and photos in step 2.

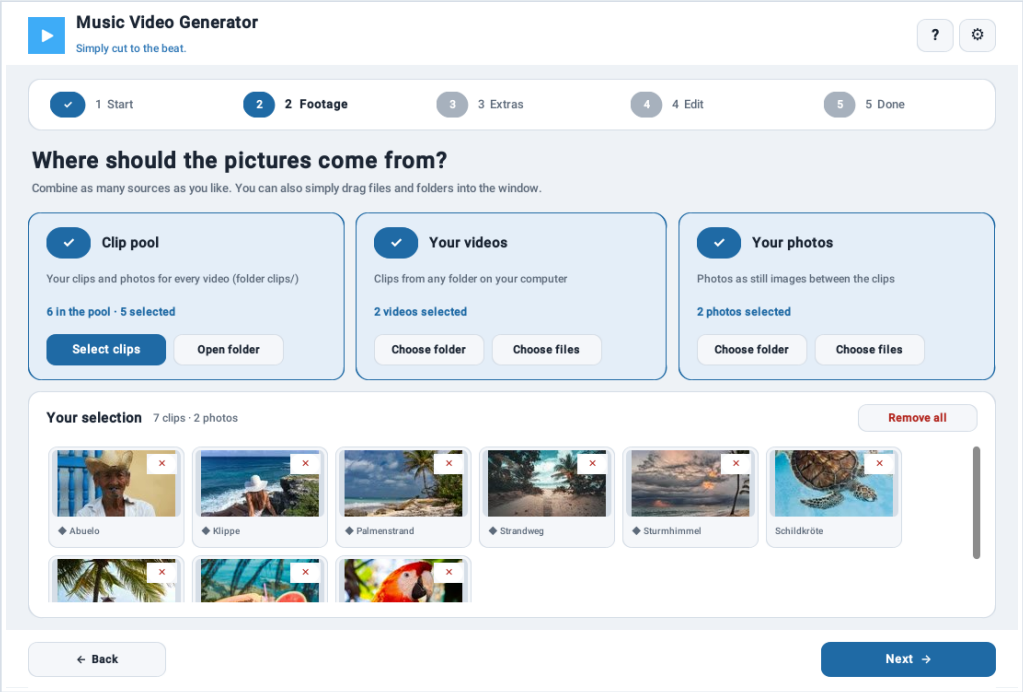
## Output formats

You can tick several formats at once; each one is created as its own file. At least one must stay active.

| Format | Description | File |
|---|---|---|
| Normal 16:9 | Landscape at full song length, with all extras. A YouTube thumbnail is saved automatically as well. | Title.mp4 |
| Normal 9:16 | Portrait at full song length, with all extras. | Title_9x16.mp4 |
| Short 9:16 · 58 s | The strongest section of the song (usually the chorus), exactly 58 s, with soft fade in and out. Never with pre-intro, intro, outro or title. | Title_Short.mp4 |

> The first ticked format is the main video: you see and arrange its clip order in step 4. Other formats are put together automatically. If you choose only the short, it is the main video and can be arranged.

# 6. Step 2 – Footage

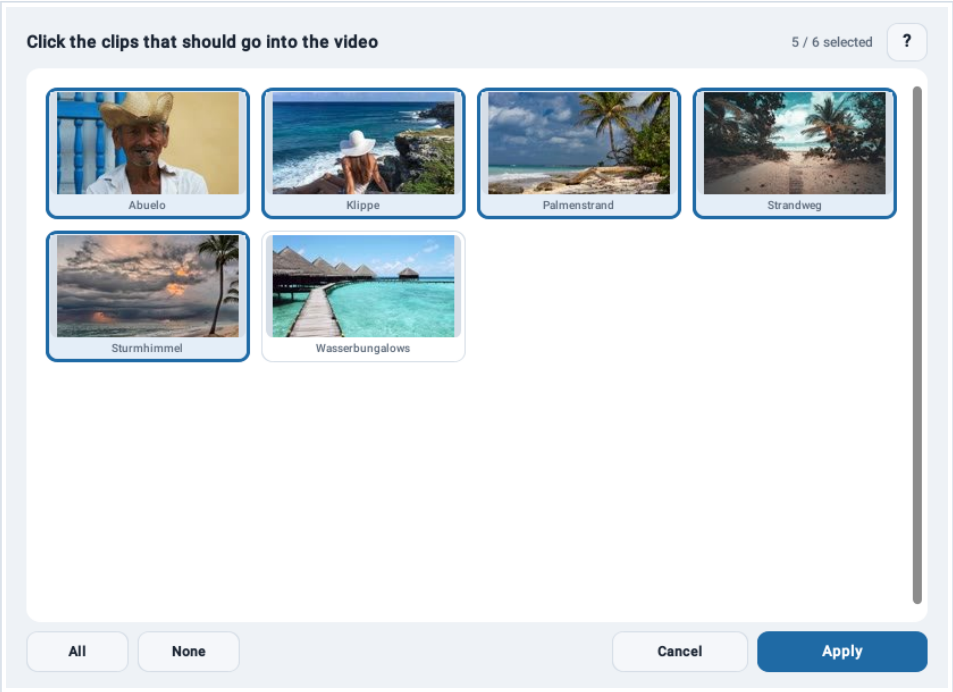



*Step 2: sources at the top, shared selection below*

Here you collect everything that goes into the video. The three sources can be combined freely:

| Source | How it works |
|---|---|
| Clip pool | “Select clips” opens a window with thumbnails of all files in the clips/ folder. Click to select (blue frame), then “Apply”. “Open folder” opens the pool in Explorer. Optional: if you create subfolders in the pool (e.g. “Beach”, “City”), each one gets its own tab in the selection window; the selection works across all tabs. Without subfolders there are no tabs. |
| Your videos | “Choose folder” adds all videos of a folder, “Choose files” individual videos. |
| Your photos | Same as videos. Photos stay on screen for the length of one cut. |

Dragging is the quickest way: drag videos, photos or whole folders from Explorer into the program window – this works in every step. A music file dragged into the window becomes the new music.



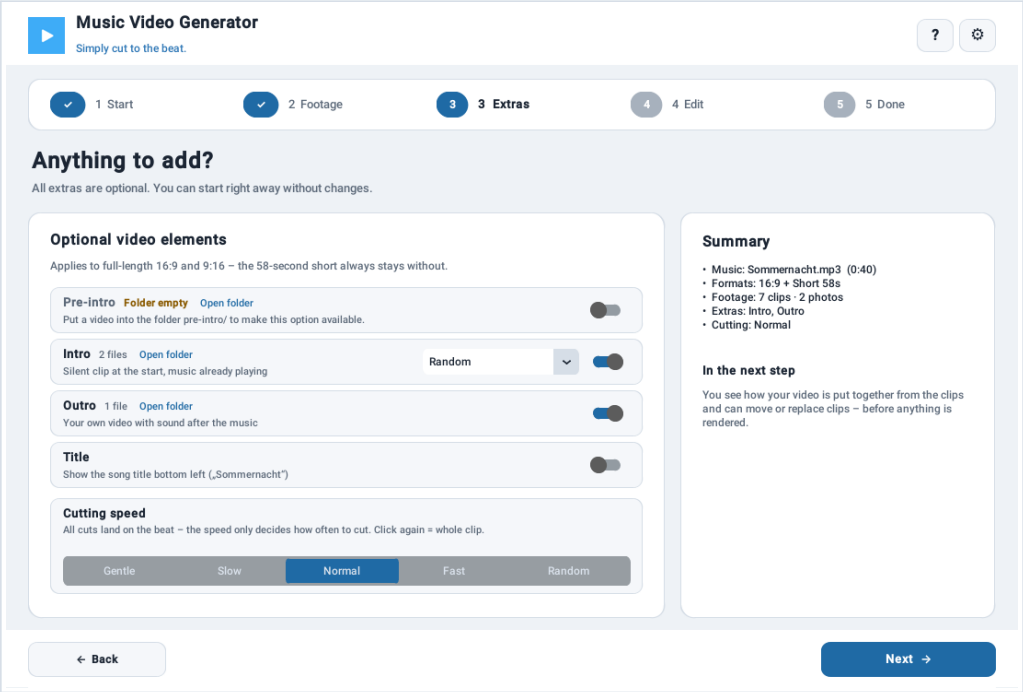

*Selecting from the clip pool*

## Your selection

- All entries are equal; the program distributes them randomly over the cuts and avoids the same clip twice in a row.
- Pool clips are marked with ◆, photos with a picture symbol.
- The × on a thumbnail removes one entry, “Remove all” empties the selection. The files themselves are never deleted.
- Duplicate files are skipped automatically.
- Photos are only used for cuts of 2 seconds or longer and at most two in a row, as soon as videos are in the selection too.

> The Windows folder dialog shows only folders, no files – a folder full of videos looks empty in it. That is normal: click the folder and confirm.

# 7. Step 3 – Extras




*Step 3: extras, cutting speed and summary*

All extras are optional. They apply to full-length 16:9 and 9:16; the 58-second short always stays without. If the matching folder is empty, the switch is locked – put a video into it (“Open folder”); the option becomes available as soon as you return to the program window.

| Extra | Effect |
|---|---|
| Pre-intro | Your own video with its own sound BEFORE the music (e.g. greeting, channel jingle). The video gets longer by the pre-intro length. |
| Intro | Silent clip at the start of the song, the music is already playing. Part of the song length – the video does not get longer. |
| Outro | Your own video with its own sound AFTER the music (e.g. end card, subscribe reminder). The video gets longer by the outro length. |
| Title | The song title appears at the bottom left after pre-intro and intro, fades in softly and out again after a few seconds. |

If there are several videos in intro/, outro/ or pre-intro/, a selection box appears next to the switch: “Random” (default) picks one at random each time, or you choose a specific video. The choice is remembered; the summary shows the chosen video in brackets.

## How the video is put together

| Pre-intro | Intro | Clips on the beat | Outro |
|---|---|---|---|
| own sound | silent, music plays | Music | own sound |

◄ Song length ►

Without an outro the video ends softly: in the last second picture and sound fade out gently instead of stopping abruptly. With an outro, the outro plays to its own end as usual; the Short

9:16 · 58 s has its own fade-in and fade-out.

## Cutting speed

| Setting | Cut about every | Effect |
|---|---|---|
| Gentle | 3.5 s | calm, atmospheric – for ballads |
| Slow | 2.2 s | cinematic |
| Normal | 1.7 s | balanced (default) – usually fits bachata and merengue |
| Fast | 0.95 s | energetic – for reggaeton and dance music |
| Random | 0.95–3.5 s | every cut random, varied |

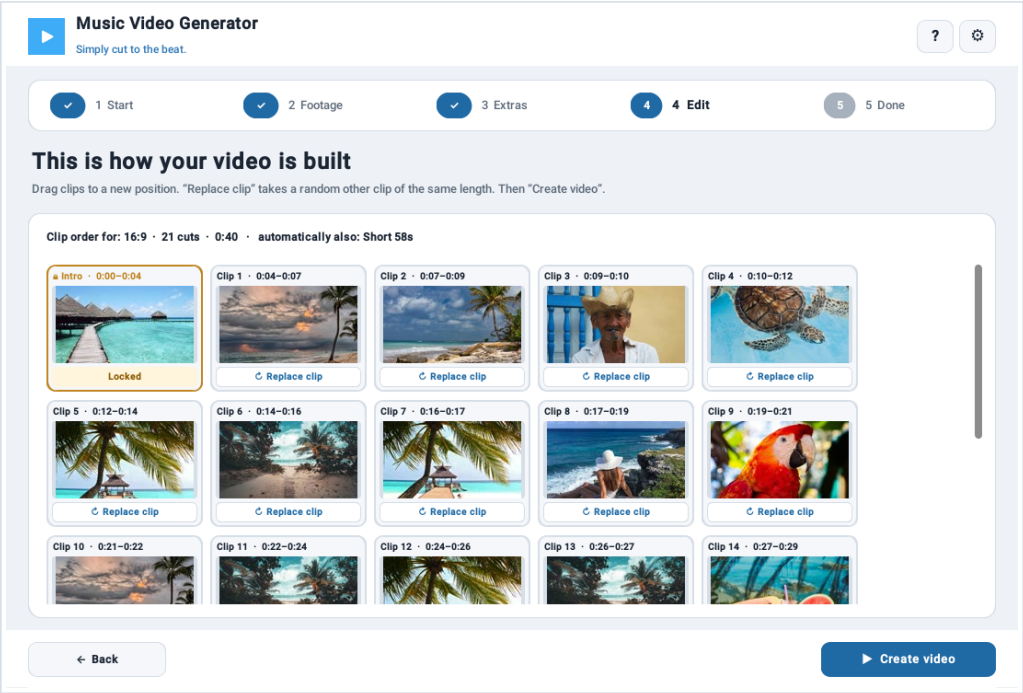
All cuts are on the beat; the speed only decides how many beats lie between two cuts. In the portrait formats Gentle and Slow are tightened a little.

## Whole clip

If you click the selected speed a second time, nothing is selected any more – the note above then reads “Nothing selected: every clip plays in full”. In this mode every clip plays completely from start to end, no matter how long it is. The cut lands on the last beat before the end of the clip, so at most a fraction of a second is lost. Photos stay for 4 seconds. In step 4 every clip keeps its length: if you move or replace a clip, the following cuts move with it. Clicking a speed switches back.

# 8. Step 4 – Edit

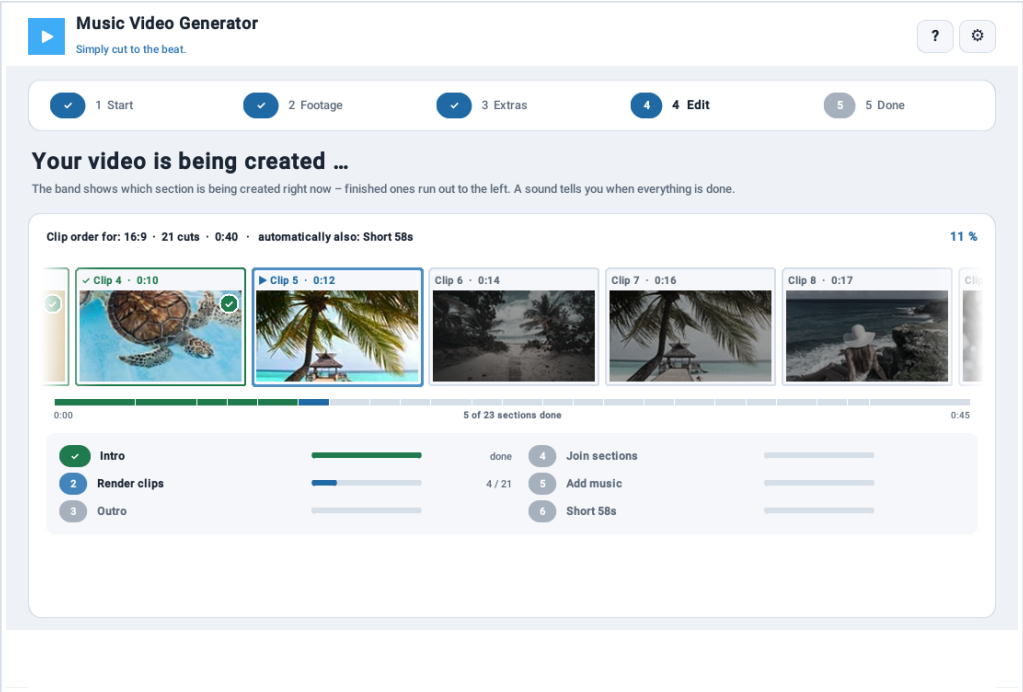
With “Next” in step 3 the program plans the clip order: it analyses the music, places the cuts on the beat and assigns a clip to every section. This only takes seconds – nothing is rendered yet. Meanwhile you see the work steps as a list, each with its own small bar; finished steps get a green tick.




*Step 4: the planned clip order*

- Every tile is one section of the video; at the top you see the time in the finished video.
- Move: drag a tile with the mouse button held down onto another one – the clips swap places, the section lengths stay on the beat.
- “Replace clip” puts in a random other clip of the same length from your selection; clips not yet used are preferred.
- Pre-intro, intro and outro are locked (padlock) and stay in place.
- The thumbnails show the original clips at the spot used, not yet cropped to the format.

“▶ Create video” renders exactly this clip order. Instead of the grid a band with the sections runs through the picture: the section being created stands in the left third (framed in blue), finished ones get a green tick and run out to the left. The strip below shows the whole video at a glance. Below that the work steps are listed with their own bars – also for other formats such as the short that are created automatically. The overall progress in percent is shown at the top right, after a few seconds with the estimated time left (“approx. 2 min left”). A sound signals the end.

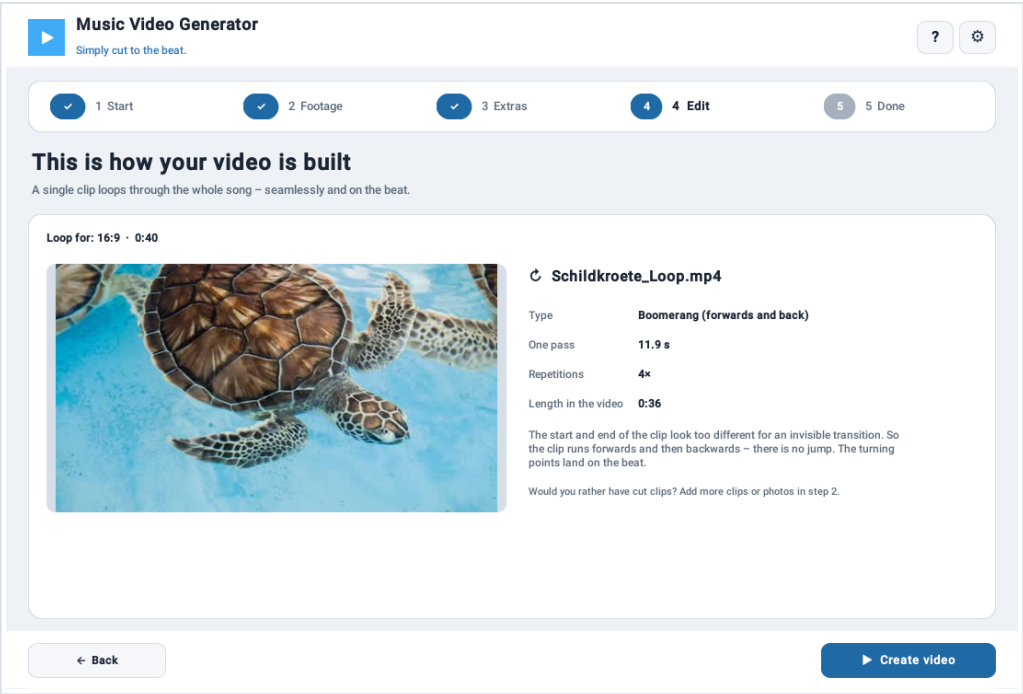



*Live view while rendering*

> An existing video is only overwritten once the new one is completely finished. If something fails, the old video is kept and the cause is shown.

## Only one clip: loop

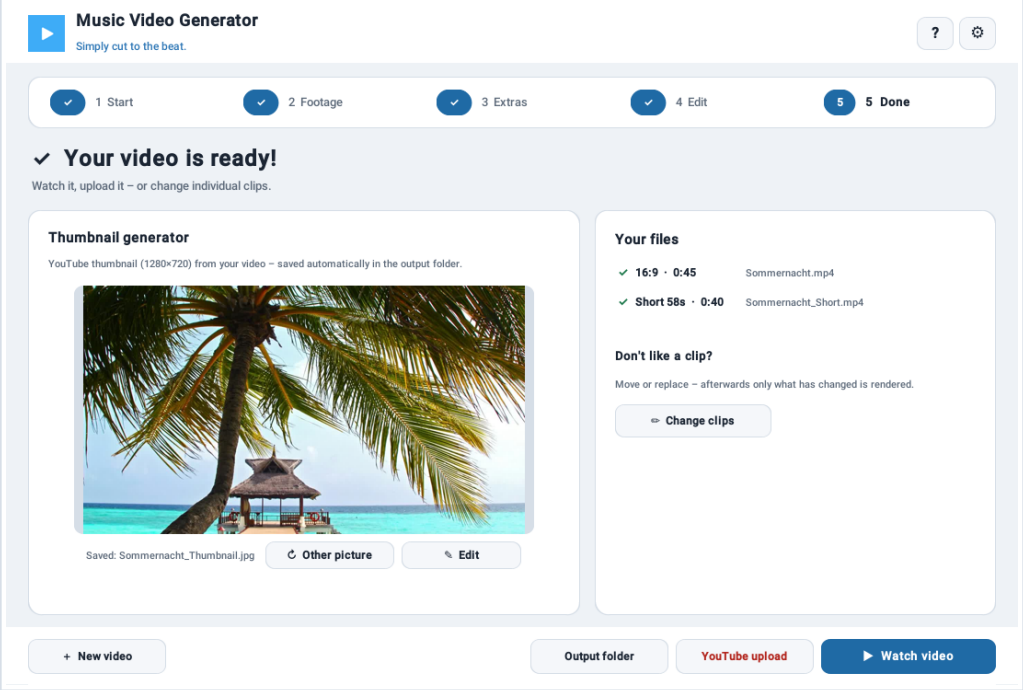
If the selection contains exactly one video and no photo, this clip automatically loops through the whole song – the cutting speed does not matter then. Step 2 shows the note “↻ Only one clip”, in step 3 the cutting speed is greyed out, and step 4 shows a loop card instead of the tiles.




*Step 4 with only one clip: the loop card*

- Seamless loop: the program looks for two points in the clip that look very similar, loops exactly between them, adds a short crossfade at the transition and matches the length of one pass to the beat.
- Boomerang: if the start and end look too different, the clip runs forwards and then backwards – without a jump, the turning points land on the beat.
- If the clip is longer than the song, it does not loop: it simply plays and ends with the music.
- Only one pass is rendered; the repetitions are then joined without re-encoding. Pre-intro, intro, outro and title work as usual.

# 9. Step 5 – Done



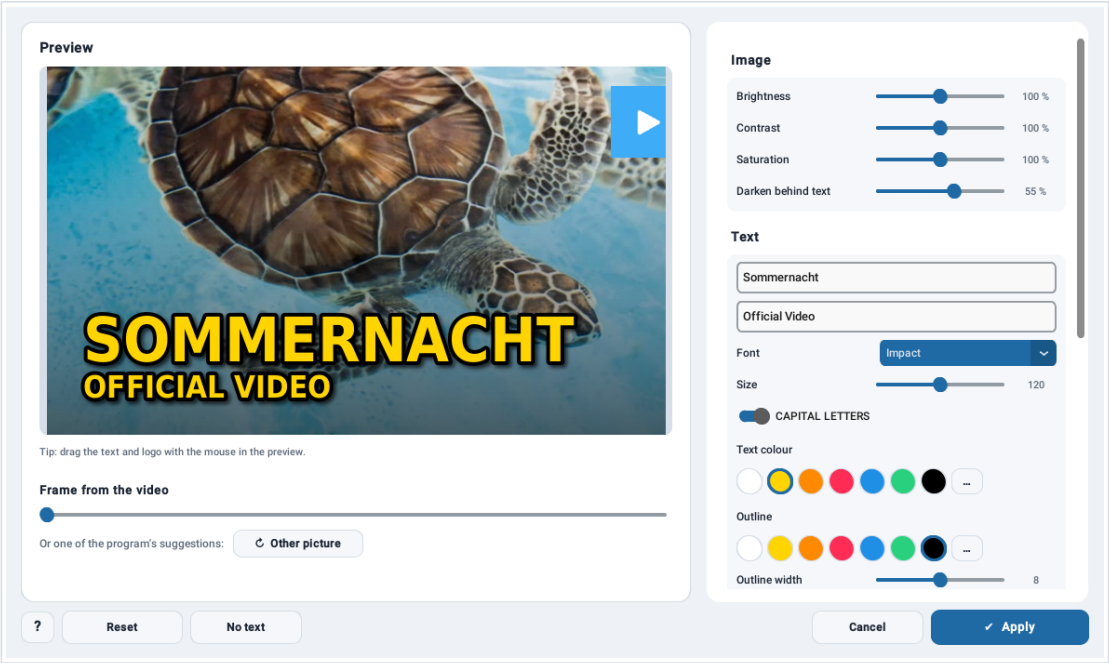

*Step 5: thumbnail generator and files*

## Thumbnail generator

For the 16:9 video the program automatically creates a YouTube thumbnail (1280×720, JPG) and saves it as “Title_Thumbnail.jpg” in the output/ folder. It picks a colourful, bright, clear still from your clips. “↻ Other picture” takes the next one and overwrites the file immediately – there is nothing extra to save. For portrait only, just a preview is shown, because YouTube takes the picture from the video for Shorts.

## Editing the thumbnail

“✎ Edit” opens the tool palette. As long as you do not use it, everything stays as described above: the thumbnail is created automatically, without text. On the left you see a large preview that shows every change immediately, below it a slider to pick any frame of the finished video. “Apply” saves the thumbnail (1280×720, JPG, below 2 MB).




*The thumbnail tool palette*

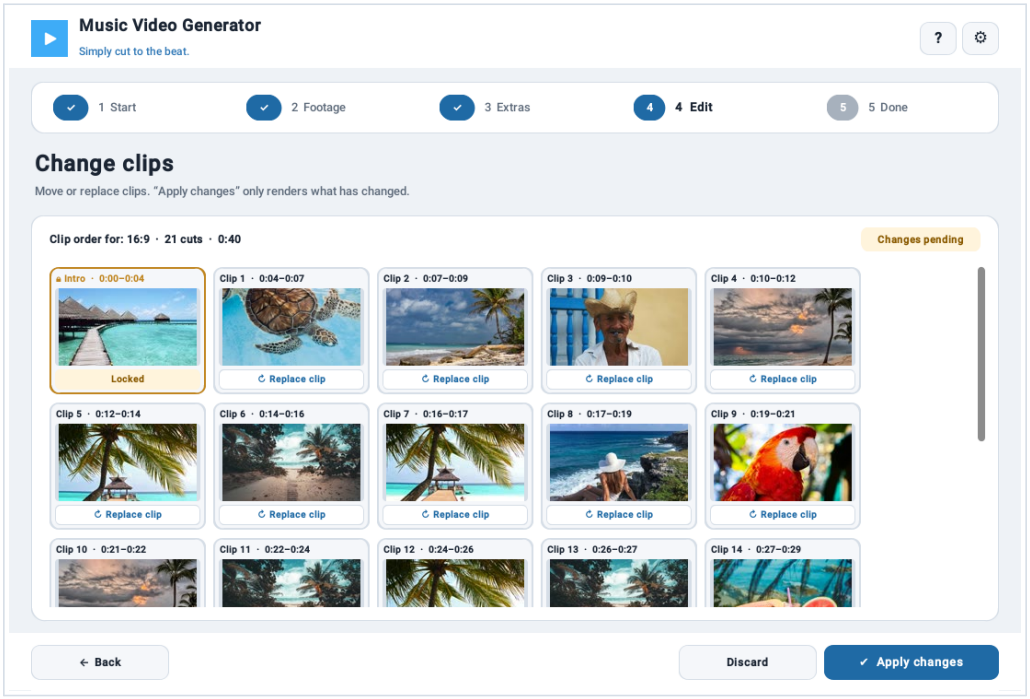
| Tool | Function |
|---|---|
| Image | Brightness, contrast, saturation and a soft gradient that darkens behind the text. |
| Text | Two lines (line 1 is the song title), font, size, capital letters, text colour, outline, shadow and position (3×3 grid or drag freely with the mouse in the preview). Texts that are too wide are reduced automatically. |
| Logo | Put your own PNG (ideally with a transparent background) in a corner or move it freely, size adjustable. |
| Template | Save and load your style. Optionally the template is applied automatically to every new thumbnail. |
| Buttons | Apply, Cancel (Esc), Reset and “No text” (only the chosen picture). |

## Buttons

| Button | Function |
|---|---|
| ▶ Watch video | Opens the main video in the default video player (with sound). |
| ✎ Edit | Opens the thumbnail tool palette (only for the 16:9 video). |
| Output folder | Opens the folder with all videos and the thumbnail. |
| YouTube upload | Opens the YouTube upload page in the browser. The program itself uploads nothing. |
| ✏ Change clips | Back to step 4 to move or replace clips. |
| + New video | Starts at step 1 with new music. Formats, extras, cutting and selection are kept. |

### Changing clips afterwards

With “✏ Change clips” (or step 4 in the step bar) you see the clip order of the finished video. After a change, “Changes pending” appears and the button becomes “✔ Apply changes”. Only what has changed is rendered: moved clips are only joined again, a replaced clip is rendered as a single section. “Discard” restores the state of the finished video and takes you back to the Done page.




*Changing clips after rendering*

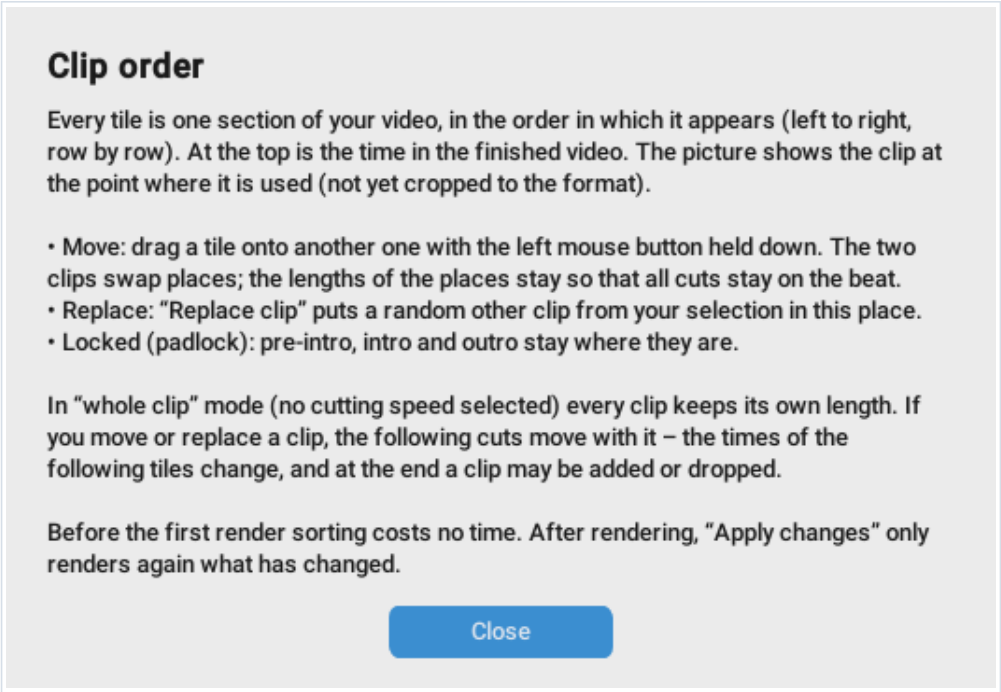
> When applying, only the main video is created again; an additionally created short stays unchanged. If the title is switched on, the video has to be re-encoded while joining – this takes a little longer than without a title.

If you change music, footage, extras, main format or cutting after rendering, the clip order is re-planned. The program asks first, so your arrangement is not lost by accident.

# 10. Help and settings

### Click help (?)

After clicking “?” a blue bar appears at the top. Move the mouse over the window – the bar shows what can be explained. A click opens the detailed explanation; afterwards click help switches off by itself. While it is active, nothing is triggered. To end without an explanation: Esc. The thumbnail editor and the pool window have their own “?” button – click help works there in the same way.




*Example of a click-help explanation*

## ⚙ menu

| Entry | Function |
|---|---|
| Click help / Quick guide / PDF manual | Help at three levels. The PDF manuals are built into the EXE; if a PDF lies next to the EXE, that one is opened. |
| Short from URL (clipboard) | Copy a YouTube link, then choose this entry: a 45-second portrait short with original sound from the strongest section is created and saved in output/Shorts. The first time a small extra component is downloaded (internet needed). A small window immediately shows the link, the video title and the work steps with progress; at the end it shows the file name with “Open folder”, or the reason in red if there is a problem. The window can be closed at any time; the short keeps being made in the background. Please only use videos you have the rights to. |
| Open pool folder / Output folder | Opens the folders in Explorer. |
| Language / Sprache | Deutsch, English, Español – the same selection screen as on first start; switches immediately, no restart. Esc or ✕ goes back without changes. |
| Appearance | System (like Windows), Light or Dark – immediately, remembered. |
| Empty cache | Deletes the temporary files (size shown next to it). Normally not needed; the program tidies up by itself. Videos, clips and settings are kept. |
| Reset settings | Everything back to the start. The cache can optionally be emptied. Videos and clips are kept. |
| Mobile version | Opens the GitHub page of MVG Mobile. |
| Report a problem | Creates an error report (ZIP file on the desktop) with logs and technical details. If you know the developer, send it directly; otherwise “Report on GitHub” opens the bug report page – drag the ZIP file into the text field there. |
| About MVG | Version and update check, copyright and license, links to the homepage, GitHub and “Report a bug”, “☕ Support MVG” and the licenses of the programs used. |

## About MVG and updates

At start-up MVG quietly asks GitHub whether there is a newer version. If so, a notice “⬆ Version … available” appears at the top in the header; a click opens the download page. Nothing is installed automatically, and only the request for the version number is sent. Without internet nothing happens.

The “About MVG” window (⚙ → About MVG) shows the version and whether it is up to date, the copyright (© 2026 Michael Beyer (loopweb), MIT License) and links to the homepage, to GitHub and for reporting bugs. “Licenses” shows MVG's license text and the programs used with their licenses – including FFmpeg, which is built into the EXE. MVG is free; if you like, you can support it with a coffee via “☕ Support MVG”.

# 11. Tips and troubleshooting

| Problem | Solution |
|---|---|
| “Next” stays grey | Step 1 is missing the music, step 2 the footage. The status line tells you what is missing. |
| Pool card says “Pool folder is still empty” | Put videos into the clips/ folder (⚙ → Open pool folder). Subfolders are shown as tabs – but only one level deep, and only if they contain videos or photos. |
| Switch for intro/outro/pre-intro is locked | The matching folder is empty. Put a video into it and return to the program window. |
| Dragging into the window does not work | The status line then says “Drag and drop is not available”. The buttons always work. |
| First render takes long (“Preparing clip …”) | Clips in special formats (e.g. 4K or HEVC from a phone) are prepared once and stored; the progress is shown in percent. Further renders are faster. |
| Cache uses a lot of space | ⚙ → Empty cache. The next render then takes a little longer. |
| Program hangs or shows an error | ⚙ → Report a problem (or the “Report a problem” button next to the error) and send the ZIP file from the desktop to the developer. This also works after a restart. |
| An error is shown | Read the cause (red), fix it, “Try again”. Details are in logs/mvg_error.log, or ⚙ → Report a problem. |

## Tips

- The more varied the material, the more varied the video.
- Put several files into intro/, outro/ or pre-intro/ – the program picks one at random, or you choose a specific one in step 3.
- For several songs with the same material: after the first video use “+ New video” – selection and settings are kept.
- The short 9:16 · 58 s is ready for Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts and TikTok.
- On the go: MVG Mobile for your phone (⚙ → Mobile version).